STRATEGIC BRAND MANAGEMENT

zouk.

Brand Audit

STRATEGIC BRAND MANAGEMENT

Submitted to

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Learning Team: 9

MODERN ROOTS
BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

INDIAN
CRAFTSMANSHIP
FOR A
BOLDER YOU





Zouk Is Scaling Fast — But Premium Equity Is Being Tested.

A modern Indian bags & accessories brand for today's woman.

₹125 Cr	+60.7%	₹19 Cr	~₹610 Cr	12L+	100+	70+
FY25 Revenue	YoY Growth	FY25 Loss	Pre-Series C Valuation	Customers	Bag Designs	Prints

WHAT ZOUK PROMISES

Vegan · Handcrafted · Indian · Modern

WHAT CUSTOMERS EXPERIENCE

Durability concerns · Warranty friction · Fulfilment issues · Service concerns

"Premium equity is being built faster than customer trust."

ROOTED IN INDIA.
MADE FOR YOU.





The Front End Looks Premium.
The Back End Feels Low Trust.

1.6 / 5
★☆☆☆☆
Trustpilot Score
VERY POOR

24
Total Reviews

100%
1-Star Reviews
in Last 12 Months
★☆☆☆

Looks premium here...



...but the experience tells a different story.

RECURRING CUSTOMER COMPLAINTS

Durability
Straps and stitching fail within weeks.

Warranty
Disputes over stitching failures.

Fulfilment
Orders stuck for 15+ days, wrong items.

Customer Service
Slow responses and refund delays.

59 – 74%
OFF ON NYKAA LISTINGS

Premium craft story + celebrity-led branding but structurally discounted 59–74% with thin per-SKU review counts despite 12L+ customers.

THE BOTTOM LINE

> The customer sees a premium brand before purchase — but may experience a low-trust seller after purchase.

Front End
App + Campaigns + Marketplace
PREMIUM

→

Back End
Fulfilment + Quality + Service Recovery
LOW TRUST

Source: Trustpilot (zouk.co.in) | Nykaa listings | Zouk Brand Audit

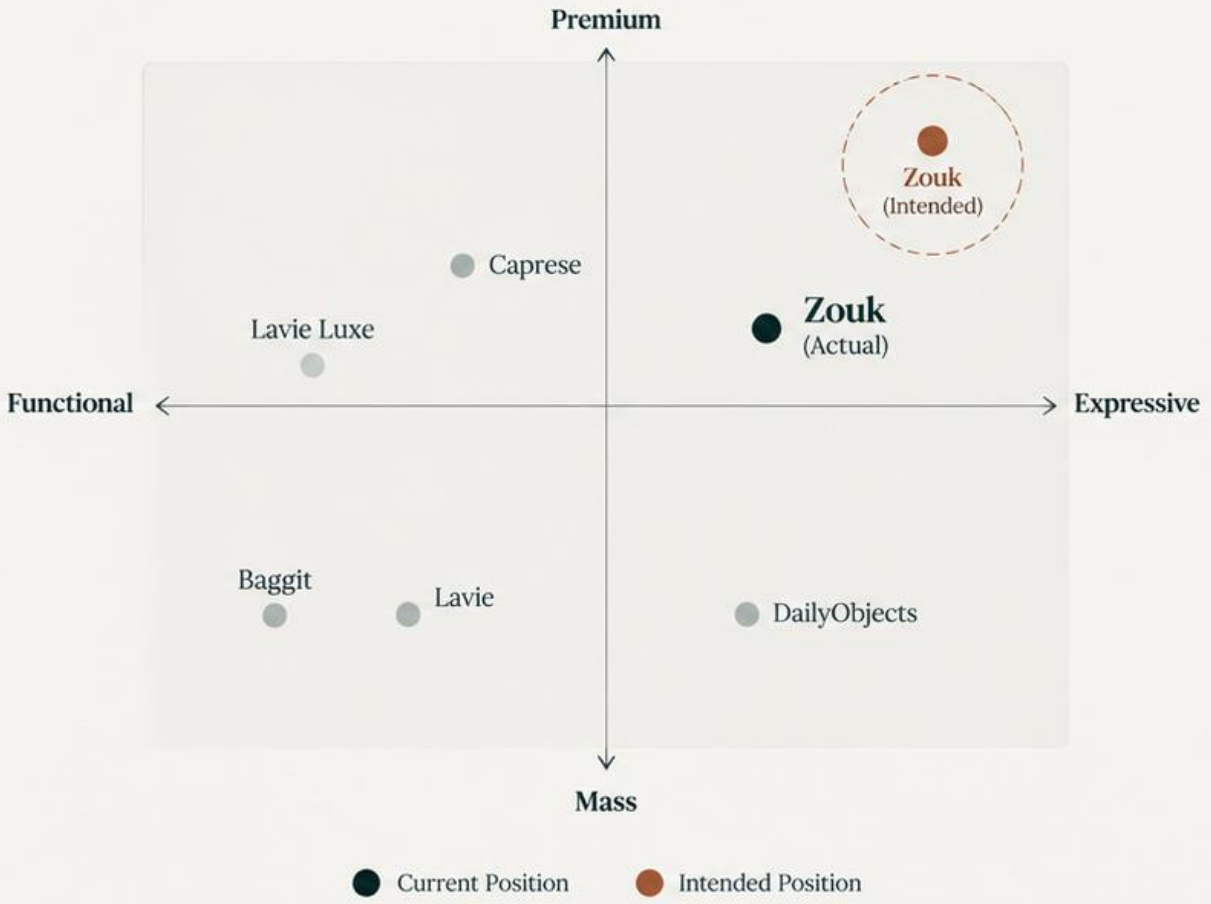
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CARRY
CULTURE
FORWARD



PEOPLE | PRINTS | PURPOSE

Zouk Wants to Own
Premium + Expressive + Indian.



THE GAP

Zouk has adopted premium codes — celebrity collaborations, Indian craft storytelling, elevated visuals — without the operational codes that make premium claims credible.

KEY COMPARISONS

ZOUK

Celebrity collabs + craft storytelling + elevated visuals.

CAPRESE

VIP Industries manufacturing backing + hardware reliability + consistent quality.

REVERSE EXAMPLE

Lavie Luxe moved existing customer trust upward into premium — the opposite sequence of Zouk's.

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BAGS
THAT CARRY
A BIGGER
STORY



PEOPLE | PRINTS | PURPOSE

From Craft to Customer. A Seamless Journey.

A simple, efficient journey that brings Indian craftsmanship from artisans to modern customers.

Raw Materials
Sustainable & ethically sourced



Artisan Production
Handcrafted by skilled artisans



Quality Check
Assured quality & finishing



Distribution
Online marketplaces & own channels



Customers
Modern, conscious consumers



A responsible value chain for a better tomorrow.

100+
Artisans Empowered

12L+
Happy Customers

100+
Unique Designs

MORE THAN A BAG

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PEOPLE
PRINTS
PURPOSE



MODERN
INDIAN
ESSENTIALS

Fix Trust Before Scaling Reach.

"Zouk's marketing engine is outrunning its operational trust."

MARKETING INVESTMENT

Celebrity collabs + Elevated campaigns + Retail expansion + Customer acquisition

→

CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

Quality failures + Warranty friction + Fulfilment breakdown + Unresponsive service

→

BRAND EQUITY LEAK

Marketing builds desire. Operations can destroy the equity.

FOUR RECOMMENDATIONS

01 — Fix the Failure Points

Run a focused strap-and-stitching QC audit before the next major product drop — the top recurring complaint, not a vague quality fix.

02 — Rewrite the Warranty

Make the warranty genuinely "uncompromising." Stop defaulting to wear-and-tear rejection where product failures are legitimate.

03 — CX KPIs Beside Marketing KPIs

Track repeat purchase rate, review sentiment, complaints and refund resolution on the same dashboard as reach, engagement and conversion.

04 — Sequence Retail Expansion

Hold the 75-store push until service capacity, returns infrastructure and support can scale with order volume.

TODAY Marketing-led growth → **PRIORITY** Operational trust → **THEN** Sustainable premium equity

"Build the experience that the marketing is already promising."